

Cyber Threat Identification

Day 3 Task • Cyber Security Track • Veda Technology Internship • Ritu Raj

Objective

Recognize common cybersecurity threats such as phishing, malware, ransomware, social engineering, and credential theft by identifying their targets, impact, and prevention strategies.

Threat Classification Table

Threat	Description	Target	Impact	Prevention
Phishing	Fraudulent emails or messages impersonating a trusted source to trick users into revealing information or clicking malicious links.	Employees, individuals, email/messaging users	Credential theft, financial loss, malware infection	Email filtering, user awareness training, MFA, verify sender domains, avoid clicking unknown links.
Malware	Malicious software (viruses, worms, trojans, spyware) designed to damage or gain unauthorized access to systems.	Endpoints, servers, networks	Data loss, system downtime, unauthorized access	Antivirus/EDR software, regular patching, restrict admin privileges, avoid untrusted downloads.
Ransomware	Malware that encrypts files or systems and demands payment for the decryption key.	Organizations, hospitals, individuals, critical infrastructure	Data unavailability, financial extortion, operational shutdown	Regular offline backups, patch management, network segmentation, endpoint protection, avoid phishing links.
Social Engineering	Manipulating people psychologically into breaking security procedures (pretexting, tailgating, baiting).	Employees, help desk staff, individuals	Unauthorized access, data breach, credential exposure	Security awareness training, verify identities, strict access policies, report suspicious contact.
Credential Theft	Stealing usernames and passwords via keyloggers, phishing, brute force, or data breaches.	User accounts, login systems	Account takeover, identity theft, lateral movement in networks	Strong unique passwords, MFA, password managers, monitor for leaked credentials.

Interview Questions & Answers

Q: What is phishing?

A: Phishing is a social engineering attack where attackers send fraudulent emails, texts, or messages that appear to come from a trusted source, aiming to trick victims into revealing sensitive information (like login credentials or financial details) or installing malware.

Q: What is ransomware?

A: Ransomware is a type of malicious software that encrypts a victim's files or entire system, blocking access until a ransom is paid to the attacker for the decryption key. It can spread through phishing emails, malicious

downloads, or exploited vulnerabilities.

Q: What is social engineering?

A: Social engineering is the psychological manipulation of people into performing actions or divulging confidential information. Instead of exploiting technical vulnerabilities, it exploits human trust through tactics such as pretexting, baiting, tailgating, and impersonation.

Approach

Researched each threat category using standard cybersecurity references (e.g., OWASP, CISA guidance) and organized the findings into a structured classification table covering the threat, its typical target, its impact, and applicable prevention measures.

Outcome

Gained a clearer understanding of how common cyber threats operate, who they typically target, and the combination of technical controls and human awareness needed to prevent them. This forms a foundation for identifying threats in real-world security assessments.